Macroeconomics I — MPE Insper

Practice list: The New Keynesian AS–AD model (Prova 01 remediation, Q3)

Solutions and grading rubric

Instructions. Multiple choice: mark the single correct option (no penalty for wrong answers). *True/False*: every 2 wrong items cancel 1 right one (score = $\max\{0, \text{right} - \text{wrong}/2\}\times$ item value); blank items do not count. Discursive questions: show every step. Parameters are symbols with the stated admissible ranges; answers are closed forms, conditions, signs and limits.

Notation (as in Prova 01; Benigno 2015). Lower-case letters are logs (deviations from the steady state); bars denote the long run; $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$; $\rho \equiv -\ln\beta$, so $-\sigma \ln\beta = \sigma\rho$.

$$y = \bar{y} + (g - \bar{g}) - \sigma[i - (\bar{p} - p)] - \sigma \ln\beta, \tag{AD}$$

$$p - p^e = \kappa(y - y_n), \tag{AS}$$

$$y_n = \tfrac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, a + \tfrac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, g - \tfrac{1}{\Omega}\, \mu, \tag{YN}$$

$$\bar{y} = \tfrac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, \bar{a} + \tfrac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, \bar{g} - \tfrac{1}{\Omega}\, \bar{\mu}, \tag{YB}$$

$$y_e = \tfrac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, a + \tfrac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, g, \tag{YE}$$

$$L = \tfrac{1}{2}(y - y_e)^2 + \tfrac{\phi}{2\kappa}(p - p^e)^2, \qquad \phi \geq 0 \qquad \text{(loss of the central bank)}. \tag{LF}$$

a, μ, g are current productivity, (log) markup and public spending; $\bar{a}, \bar{\mu}, \bar{g}$ their long-run values. Parameters: $\sigma, \eta, \kappa > 0$. Unless stated, the economy starts at an efficient steady state ($y = y_n = y_e = \bar{y}$, $p = p^e = \bar{p}$, $g = \bar{g}$; a subsidy offsets the steady-state markup, so $\mu, \bar{\mu}$ are deviations from it), the bank sets i, and p^e and $\bar{p}$ do not move. "Shock" means a change $d(\cdot)$ from that point.

Block 1 — Exam level: Benigno's own experiments, Lista 7 and Carlin–Soskice

(Benigno §§6, 7, 11 • 40 points)

Question 1. (10 points) *Source: built on Benigno, P. (2015), "New-Keynesian Economics: An AS–AD View", §6.1–§6.2, Figs. 6–7, p. 512 — the article has no exercises; the statement below is ours. The article treats a productivity* gain*; here the sign is reversed.* Redo the two experiments of those sections for a productivity *fall*, $da < 0$.

What the article states (p. 512): "First, we analyze the case in which the economy undergoes a temporary productivity gain, meaning that productivity rises in the short run but does not vary in the long run." (§6.1) and "Fig. 7 analyzes the case of a permanent productivity shock." (§6.2)

a) (4 points) The fall is temporary ($d\bar{a} = 0$) and i stays at its initial level. Which curve moves, in which direction and why? Find dy, dp, $d(y - y_n)$ and $d(y - y_e)$ in closed form, with signs.

Notation.

- y, p: log output and log price level today. $\bar{y}$, $\bar{p}$: their long-run values ($\bar{p}$ fixed throughout).
- p^e: the price preset by the firms that cannot adjust this period (fixed unless stated).
- y_n: natural output (flexible prices, with the markup), (YN). y_e: efficient output (no markup), (YE). $y - y_n$ and $y - y_e$: the two output gaps.
- i: nominal interest rate, the bank's instrument. $\rho \equiv -\ln\beta > 0$, with $\beta \in (0, 1)$ the discount factor.
- a, $\bar{a}$: productivity today and in the long run. μ, $\bar{\mu}$: desired markup today and in the long run. g, $\bar{g}$: public spending today and in the long run.
- $\sigma > 0$: intertemporal elasticity of substitution. $\eta > 0$: inverse Frisch elasticity. $\kappa > 0$: slope of (AS). $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta > 0$.
- $d(\cdot)$: the change of a variable from the initial efficient steady state. Here $da < 0$ and $d\bar{a} = 0$.
- (M): the gap equation derived in the first step; every later question of the list uses it.

Step — the machine. $\ln\beta$ is a constant. Differentiate (AD):

$$dy = d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - \sigma\, di + \sigma\, d\bar{p} - \sigma\, dp. \tag{1}$$

Differentiate (AS):

$$dp = dp^e + \kappa\,(dy - dy_n). \tag{2}$$

Substitute (2) for dp in (1):

$$\begin{aligned} dy &= d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - \sigma\, di + \sigma\, d\bar{p} - \sigma\big(dp^e + \kappa\,(dy - dy_n)\big) \\ &= d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - \sigma\, di + \sigma(d\bar{p} - dp^e) - \sigma\kappa\, dy + \sigma\kappa\, dy_n. \end{aligned}$$

Move $-\sigma\kappa\, dy$ to the left side:

$$(1+\sigma\kappa)\, dy = d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - \sigma\, di + \sigma(d\bar{p} - dp^e) + \sigma\kappa\, dy_n. \tag{3}$$

Subtract $(1+\sigma\kappa)\, dy_n$ from both sides of (3):

$$(1+\sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) = d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - \sigma\, di + \sigma(d\bar{p} - dp^e) - dy_n. \tag{M}$$

Every later answer is (M) with the right entries; (2) then gives the price, $dp - dp^e = \kappa\, d(y - y_n)$.

Step — curves. Differentiate (YN) with only a moving:

$$dy_n = \frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, da < 0. \tag{4}$$

The AS curve, (AS), passes through (y_n, p^e), so it shifts *left* (up by $\kappa|dy_n|$), through (y_n', p^e). $\bar{a}$ is unchanged, so (YB) gives $d\bar{y} = 0$, and by (1) the AD does not move. Differentiate (YE):

$$dy_e = \frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, da = dy_n. \tag{5}$$

Step — solution. Put $di = d\bar{y} = dg = d\bar{g} = d\bar{p} = dp^e = 0$ in (M):

$$(1+\sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) = -dy_n.$$

Divide by $1+\sigma\kappa$ and use the sign in (4):

$$d(y - y_n) = \frac{-dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa} > 0. \tag{6}$$

Output is capacity plus the gap, $dy = dy_n + d(y - y_n)$. Substitute (6):

$$\begin{aligned} dy &= dy_n + \Big(\frac{-dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa}\Big) \\ &= dy_n - \frac{dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa} \\ &= \frac{(1+\sigma\kappa)\, dy_n - dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa} \\ &= \frac{\sigma\kappa\, dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa} < 0. \end{aligned} \tag{7}$$

By (2) with $dp^e = 0$, $dp = \kappa\, d(y - y_n)$. Substitute (6):

$$\begin{aligned} dp &= \kappa\Big(\frac{-dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{-\kappa\, dy_n}{1+\sigma\kappa} > 0. \end{aligned} \tag{8}$$

By (5), $dy_e = dy_n$; substitute it into $d(y - y_e) = dy - dy_e$:

$$\begin{aligned} d(y - y_e) &= dy - (dy_n) \\ &= d(y - y_n) > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Output falls, but by less than capacity.

Economic intuition. Firms' marginal cost rises, flexible firms raise prices, the real rate $i - (\bar{p} - p)$ rises and demand falls along the AD, but only part of the way to the new, lower y_n.

Grading rubric.

- Curve and reason (y_n moves, $\bar{y}$ does not): 1.5 pts. AD shifted as well: max. 1 pt for the item.
- Closed forms with signs: 2 pts (-0.5 per arithmetic slip, method right).
- Both gaps, with $dy_e = dy_n$ stated: 0.5 pt.

b) (3 points) Find the change in i that keeps $p = p^e$. Is it a cut or a rise? What does it cost in terms of $y - y_e$?

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). New: $r_n \equiv \rho + \sigma^{-1}(\bar{y} - y_n)$, the natural real interest rate (the real rate that puts y at y_n).

Step — rate. By (2) with $dp^e = 0$, $p = p^e$ requires $y = y_n$, i.e. $d(y - y_n) = 0$. Put this and $d\bar{y} = dg = d\bar{g} = d\bar{p} = 0$ in (M):

$$0 = -\sigma\, di - dy_n.$$

Solve for di:

$$di = -\frac{dy_n}{\sigma}. \tag{9}$$

Substitute (4):

$$\begin{aligned} di &= -\frac{\left(\frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, da\right)}{\sigma} \\ &= -\frac{(1+\eta)\, da}{\sigma\Omega} > 0, \end{aligned}$$

a **rise**.

Step — cost. With $d(y - y_n) = 0$, $dy = dy_n$, and by (5) $dy_e = dy_n$. Substitute both into $d(y - y_e) = dy - dy_e$:

$$\begin{aligned} d(y - y_e) &= (dy_n) - (dy_n) \\ &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

No cost: both targets are hit with one instrument (divine coincidence).

Economic intuition. With today poorer than tomorrow, households want to borrow against the future; the natural real rate $\rho + \sigma^{-1}(\bar{y} - y_n)$ rises, and the bank must follow it up to stop demand from exceeding the reduced capacity.

Grading rubric.

- di with sign: 2 pts. A cut "to support output": 0 for the item.
- No cost, because y_e moves with y_n: 1 pt.

c) (3 points) Now the fall is permanent ($d\bar{a} = da$). Answer (a) and (b) again and explain the difference.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a), now with $d\bar{a} = da < 0$.

Step — curves. Differentiate (YB) with $d\bar{a} = da$:

$$d\bar{y} = \frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, d\bar{a} = \frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}\, da.$$

Compare with (4):

$$d\bar{y} = dy_n. \tag{10}$$

By (1), the AD shifts horizontally by $d\bar{y}$: left, by the same distance as the AS.

Step — solution. Put $di = 0$ and (10) in (M):

$$\begin{aligned} (1 + \sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) &= d\bar{y} - dy_n \\ &= (dy_n) - dy_n \\ &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

So $d(y - y_n) = 0$, and (2) gives $dp = 0$. With (5), $dy = dy_n = dy_e < 0$. The rate that keeps $p = p^e$ solves (M) with $d(y - y_n) = 0$:

$$\begin{aligned} di &= \frac{d\bar{y} - dy_n}{\sigma} \\ &= \frac{(dy_n) - dy_n}{\sigma} \\ &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

Step — difference. Temporary: only today is poorer, the natural rate rises, raise i. Permanent: today and tomorrow fall together, consumption smoothing cuts demand by exactly the fall in capacity, the natural rate is unchanged: do nothing.

Ref: Benigno (2015), §6.1–§6.2, Figs. 6–7, p. 512; `Map/benigno/05-productivity-shocks.md`, table on the three cases.

Grading rubric.

- AD shift equal to the AS shift, from $d\bar{y} = dy_n$: 1.5 pts.
- $dp = 0$, $di = 0$ and the reading: 1.5 pts.

Question 2. (10 points) *Source: built on Benigno, P. (2015), "New-Keynesian Economics: An AS–AD View", §6.3, Fig. 8, p. 513 — the article has no exercises; the statement below is ours. Item (a) redoes the article's experiment; items (b)–(c), the markup analogue, are added by this list.*
What the article states (p. 513): "Consider now the case of an expected increase in long-run productivity. [...] AS does not move, since there is no change in current productivity."

a) (4 points) Redo the optimism experiment of §6.3 in the exam notation: $d\bar{a} > 0$, $da = 0$, i fixed. Curve, dy, dp, both gaps, the di that keeps $p = p^e$ and its cost.

Notation.

- y, p, $\bar{y}$, $\bar{p}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i, a, $\bar{a}$, μ, $\bar{\mu}$, $\sigma > 0$, $\eta > 0$, $\kappa > 0$, $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$: as in Question 1.
- The shock: $d\bar{a} > 0$, $da = 0$; in (b), $d\bar{\mu} < 0$, $d\mu = 0$. $|d\bar{\mu}| = -d\bar{\mu}$ is its size.
- E_0: the initial equilibrium (y_n, p^e); E': the equilibrium after the shock with i fixed.

Step — curves. Differentiate (YB) with only $\bar{a}$ moving:

$$d\bar{y} = \frac{1 + \eta}{\Omega}\, d\bar{a} > 0. \tag{11}$$

By (1) this enters only the AD: it shifts *right* by $d\bar{y}$. (YN) and (YE) depend on current a, so $dy_n = dy_e = 0$: the AS stays.

Step — solution. Put only $d\bar{y}$ in (M):

$$d(y - y_n) = \frac{d\bar{y}}{1 + \sigma\kappa}. \tag{12}$$

Output is $dy = dy_n + d(y - y_n)$ with $dy_n = 0$; substitute (12):

$$\begin{aligned} dy &= 0 + \Big(\frac{d\bar{y}}{1 + \sigma\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{d\bar{y}}{1 + \sigma\kappa} > 0. \end{aligned} \tag{13}$$

By (2) with $dp^e = dy_n = 0$, $dp = \kappa\, dy$. Substitute (13):

$$\begin{aligned} dp &= \kappa\Big(\frac{d\bar{y}}{1 + \sigma\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{\kappa\, d\bar{y}}{1 + \sigma\kappa} > 0. \end{aligned} \tag{14}$$

Since $dy_e = 0$, $d(y - y_e) = dy > 0$.

Step — policy. $p = p^e$ needs $d(y - y_n) = 0$. Put that and di in (M):

$$0 = d\bar{y} - \sigma\, di.$$

Solve for di:

$$di = \frac{d\bar{y}}{\sigma} > 0, \tag{15}$$

a **rise**. Then $dy = dp = 0$: no cost (pure AD shock).

Economic intuition. Expected future income raises consumption today (Euler equation); capacity today has not moved, so prices rise.

Grading rubric.

- AD right, AS still, with the reason: 1.5 pts. AS shifted: max. 1 pt for the item.
- Closed forms and gaps: 1.5 pts. Policy and cost: 1 pt.

b) (4 points) Instead of $\bar{a}$, the news is that the long-run markup will *fall*, $d\bar{\mu} < 0$ (a competition reform that takes effect next period); μ does not change. Answer (a) for this shock and draw the AS–AD diagram with E_0, the new equilibrium E', the gap $y - y_n$, and the AD after the policy of price stability.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). Here $d\bar{\mu} < 0$ and $|d\bar{\mu}| = -d\bar{\mu} > 0$.

Step — mapping. Differentiate (YB) with only $\bar{\mu}$ moving:

$$d\bar{y} = -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} = \frac{|d\bar{\mu}|}{\Omega} > 0. \tag{16}$$

This is the shock of (a) with $d\bar{y} = |d\bar{\mu}|/\Omega$: AD right. (YN) contains current μ only, so $dy_n = 0$ and the AS stays.

Step — results. Substitute (16) into (13):

$$\begin{aligned} dy &= \frac{(|d\bar{\mu}|/\Omega)}{1 + \sigma\kappa} \\ &= \frac{|d\bar{\mu}|}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} > 0. \end{aligned}$$

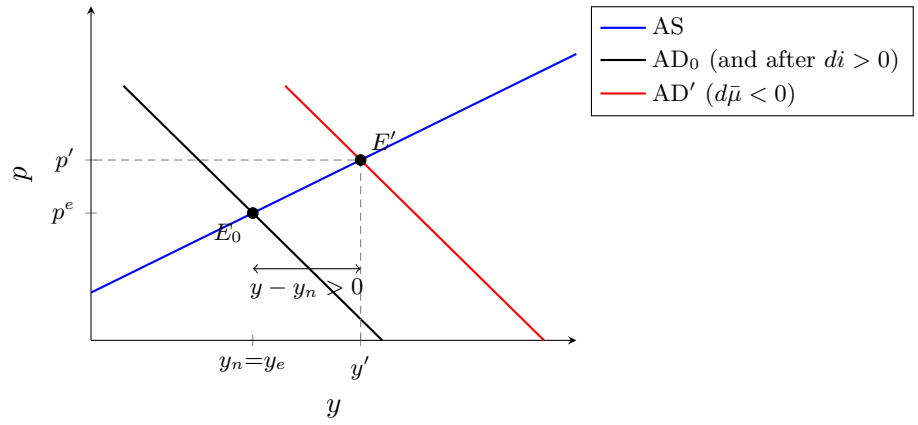
Substitute (16) into (14):

$$\begin{aligned} dp &= \frac{\kappa\,(|d\bar{\mu}|/\Omega)}{1 + \sigma\kappa} \\ &= \frac{\kappa|d\bar{\mu}|}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Since $dy_n = dy_e = 0$, $d(y - y_n) = d(y - y_e) = dy > 0$. Substitute (16) into (15):

$$\begin{aligned} di &= \frac{(|d\bar{\mu}|/\Omega)}{\sigma} \\ &= \frac{|d\bar{\mu}|}{\sigma\Omega} > 0, \end{aligned}$$

at no cost.



Drawn with $\sigma = 1$, $\kappa = 0.5$, $d\bar{y} = 1$: $E' = (2/3, 1/3)$ (check script). The rise $di = 1$ moves AD′ back onto AD$_0$.

Grading rubric.

- Curve and closed forms: 2 pts. Graph (scored on its own): axes, AS through (y_n, p^e), AD$_0$, AD′, E_0, E', gap: 2 pts.

c) (2 points) In words: what changes if the news is a *rise* in $\bar{\mu}$ (Prova 01, Q3)? Does the answer depend on ϕ?

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). Here $d\bar{\mu} > 0$, $d\mu = 0$. $\phi \geq 0$: the weight on price surprises in the loss (LF).

Step — flip. By (YB), $d\bar{y} = -d\bar{\mu}/\Omega < 0$, so every sign flips: AD left, y and p fall, $y - y_n < 0$ and $y - y_e < 0$. By (15) the bank **cuts** i:

$$\begin{aligned} di &= \frac{d\bar{y}}{\sigma} \\ &= \frac{(-d\bar{\mu}/\Omega)}{\sigma} \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} < 0, \end{aligned}$$

at no cost. The AS does not move because current μ did not change. ϕ is irrelevant: neither y_n nor y_e moved, so the optimum of the loss is the old point and the bank only undoes the AD shift ((41) in Question 4(c)).

Ref: Benigno (2015), §6.3, Fig. 8, p. 513; §4.2, p. 508 ($\bar{\mu}$ in $\bar{y}$); `Prova/prova-01-error-analysis.md`, Q3.

Grading rubric.

- AD left and a cut: 1 pt. "AS moves" or "raise i": 0 for the item. ϕ-independence with the reason: 1 pt.

Question 3. (10 points) *Source: MPE Macroeconomics I, Lista 7 (2026), Question 2, item (a) only — reproduced verbatim (its points label and item (b) omitted); built also on Benigno, P. (2015), "New-Keynesian Economics: An AS–AD View", §7, Fig. 9, pp. 513–514, which has no exercises.*

Lista 7, Question 2. Using separate AS–AD diagrams, analyze the following changes:

a) a temporary increase in firms' desired markups;

In each case, identify which curve shifts, indicate the direction of the shift, and describe the effects on output and the price level. Explain the economic intuition behind the movement of the curve and the resulting equilibrium.

What Benigno states (p. 513): "This section considers only temporary mark-up shocks, leaving other analyses to the reader."

Added parts (not in Lista 7), with the sign changed: the desired markup *falls* for one period only, $d\mu < 0$ (a temporary payroll-tax cut, or a fall in the oil price); $d\bar{\mu} = 0$. Items (a)–(c) below are this list's.

a) (3 points) With i fixed: which curve moves and where; dy, dp, $d(y - y_n)$, $d(y - y_e)$ with signs.

Notation.

- y, p, $\bar{y}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i, μ, $\bar{\mu}$, $\sigma > 0$, $\kappa > 0$, $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta > 0$: as in Question 1.
- The shock: $d\mu < 0$ for one period, $d\bar{\mu} = 0$.
- $\phi \geq 0$: weight on price surprises in (LF). y^*, p^*, i^*: the bank's optimal output, price and rate.

Step — curves. Differentiate (YN) with only μ moving:

$$dy_n = -\frac{d\mu}{\Omega} > 0. \tag{17}$$

(YE) has no μ, so $dy_e = 0$; (YB) has no current μ, so $d\bar{y} = 0$. The AS shifts *right* (down), through (y_n', p^e); by (1) the AD stays.

Step — solution. Put only dy_n in (M) and divide by $1 + \sigma\kappa$:

$$d(y - y_n) = \frac{-dy_n}{1 + \sigma\kappa} < 0. \tag{18}$$

Add dy_n to (18), as in (7):

$$\begin{aligned} dy &= dy_n + \Big(\frac{-dy_n}{1 + \sigma\kappa}\Big) \\ &= dy_n - \frac{dy_n}{1 + \sigma\kappa} \\ &= \frac{\sigma\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \sigma\kappa} > 0. \end{aligned} \tag{19}$$

By (2) with $dp^e = 0$, $dp = \kappa\, d(y - y_n)$. Substitute (18):

$$\begin{aligned} dp &= \kappa\Big(\frac{-dy_n}{1 + \sigma\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{-\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \sigma\kappa} < 0. \end{aligned} \tag{20}$$

Since $dy_e = 0$, $d(y - y_e) = dy > 0$ by (19). The two gaps have *opposite* signs: output is below natural (so prices fall) and above efficient.

Step — confirmation. This is the mirror image of Lista 7, Q2(a). The instructor's key (`Listas/soluções do instrutor/PSET 7 (1).pdf`, p. 1) shifts only the AS, to the left, with the AD fixed and $p' > p^e$; `Map/lista-07.md` (row 2a) gives $y \downarrow$, $p \uparrow$, $y - y_n > 0$, $y - y_e < 0$. Reversing the sign of $d\mu$ reverses every entry, as above.

Grading rubric.

- AS only, right: 1 pt. AD shifted: max. 1 pt for the item.
- Closed forms: 1 pt.
- Two gaps with opposite signs: 1 pt; one "output gap": 0 for this line.

b) (3 points) Find the di that keeps $p = p^e$ and the di that keeps $y = y_e$. Report $y - y_e$ in the first case and $p - p^e$ in the second. Is there a trade-off?

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a).

Step — price stability. Put $d(y - y_n) = 0$ in (M) with only di and dy_n:

$$0 = -\sigma\, di - dy_n.$$

Solve for di and substitute (17):

$$\begin{aligned} di &= -\frac{dy_n}{\sigma} \\ &= -\frac{(-d\mu/\Omega)}{\sigma} \\ &= \frac{d\mu}{\sigma\Omega} < 0, \end{aligned} \tag{21}$$

a cut. Then $dy = dy_n$ and, since $dy_e = 0$, $d(y - y_e) = dy_n > 0$.

Step — efficient output. $y = y_e$ means $dy = 0$. Put only di and dy_n in (3):

$$(1 + \sigma\kappa)\, dy = \sigma\kappa\, dy_n - \sigma\, di.$$

Set $dy = 0$ and solve for di:

$$di = \kappa\, dy_n > 0, \tag{22}$$

a rise. By (2) with $dy = 0$:

$$dp = \kappa\,(0 - dy_n) = -\kappa\, dy_n < 0.$$

Step — trade-off. (21) and (22) have opposite signs: yes, a trade-off. The shock moves y_n and not y_e.

Grading rubric.

- Each rate with sign and its outcome: 1 pt each.
- Trade-off traced to $y_n - y_e$: 1 pt.

c) (4 points) The bank minimizes L. Find dy^*, dp^* and di^*, and the condition on ϕ under which it cuts.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a); y^*, p^*, i^* and ϕ as listed there.

Step — optimum. Question 4(a) gives the optimum (31). Differentiate it with $dy_e = 0$:

$$dy^* = \frac{\phi\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa} > 0. \tag{23}$$

By (2) with $dp^e = 0$, $dp^* = \kappa(dy^* - dy_n)$. Substitute (23):

$$\begin{aligned} dp^* &= \kappa\Big(\frac{\phi\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa} - dy_n\Big) \\ &= \kappa\, \frac{\phi\kappa\, dy_n - (1 + \phi\kappa)\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{-\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa} < 0. \end{aligned} \tag{24}$$

Step — rate. Put $d\bar{y} = dg = d\bar{g} = d\bar{p} = 0$ in (1):

$$dy^* = -\sigma\, di^* - \sigma\, dp^*.$$

Solve for di^*:

$$di^* = -\frac{dy^* + \sigma\, dp^*}{\sigma}. \tag{25}$$

Add (23) and σ times (24):

$$\begin{aligned} dy^* + \sigma\, dp^* &= \Big(\frac{\phi\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa}\Big) + \sigma\Big(\frac{-\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{\phi\kappa\, dy_n - \sigma\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{\kappa(\phi - \sigma)\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa}. \end{aligned}$$

Substitute this into (25):

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= -\frac{\Big(\frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)\, dy_n}{1+\phi\kappa}\Big)}{\sigma} \\ &= -\frac{\kappa(\phi - \sigma)\, dy_n}{\sigma(1 + \phi\kappa)}. \end{aligned} \tag{26}$$

Step — sign. By (17), $dy_n > 0$. So in (26), $di^* < 0$ (cut) iff $\phi > \sigma$, and $di^* > 0$ iff $\phi < \sigma$. Compare (24) with the no-policy (20): a hawk ($\phi > \sigma$) wants less price fall than the no-policy point gives ($\frac{1}{1+\phi\kappa} < \frac{1}{1+\sigma\kappa}$), so it pushes AD right.

Ref: Benigno (2015), §7, Fig. 9, pp. 513–514; §11, p. 522 (sign of the response depends on the IT slope); `Map/benigno/06-markup-shocks.md` §6.3.

Grading rubric.

- dy^*, dp^* from $dL/dy = 0$ on AS: 2 pts. Optimisation in i without AS: max. 1 pt for the item.
- di^* and the $\phi \gtrless \sigma$ condition: 2 pts.

Question 4. (10 points) *Optimal policy. Sources: MPE Macroeconomics I, Lista 7 (2026), Question 4 — reproduced verbatim (its points label omitted); Carlin, W. and Soskice, D. (2024),* Macroeconomics: Institutions, Instability, and Inequality*, §3.6.1 checklist questions 4 and 5, p. 156 — reproduced verbatim; built also on Benigno, P. (2015), "New-Keynesian Economics: An AS–AD View", §11, eqs. (33)–(35), Fig. 14, pp. 521–523, which has no exercises.*

Lista 7, Question 4. The microeconomic foundations of the New Keynesian model make it possible to evaluate monetary policy in terms of household welfare.

Consider the following loss function in conjunction with the AS-AD dynamics seen in Benigno (2015)

$$\min_{y,p} \mathcal{L} = \phi_y(y - y^*)^2 + \phi_p(p - p^e)^2, \qquad \phi_y, \phi_p > 0,$$

s.t:

$$p - p^e = \kappa(y - y_n).$$

Interpret the shape of the loss function and analyse what it implies for the behavior of a central bank. Also, explain why this problem is subjected to the AS condition and what does that mean in terms of economic policy

Carlin and Soskice, checklist questions 4 and 5.

4. Explain what is meant by the central bank's loss function. How are the central bank's preferences reflected in the loss function? Draw the loss 'circles' for the cases where
   (a) $\beta = 1$;
   (b) $\beta < 1$;
   (c) $\beta > 1$.

   In which of the three cases will the central bank reduce inflation back to target quickest after an inflation shock? Is there any downside to adopting this policy stance?
5. Assume that $\alpha = \beta = 1$, derive the MR curve graphically using the tangencies between the loss circles and the Phillips curves. With reference to the diagrams, explain the effect of the following (in each case, assume all other parameters are held constant):
   (a) An increase in the slope of the Phillips curve, α
   (b) An increase in central bank's inflation aversion, β.

What Benigno states (p. 522): "This rule is robust to all types of shock and does not depend on their properties."

Added parts (not in the sources): items (a)–(c) below are this list's. They ask the questions above in Benigno's static model and with the loss L of the cover: ϕ plays the role of Carlin and Soskice's β, κ of their α, the IT line of their MR curve.

a) (4 points) Minimize L subject to the AS. Derive the targeting rule, explain why the AS (and not the AD) is the constraint, and describe the loss contours and the IT line. Show that the Lista 7 loss $\phi_y(y - y^*)^2 + \phi_p(p - p^e)^2$ gives the same rule for suitable weights.

Notation.

- y, p: log output and price level. y_n, y_e: natural and efficient output, (YN) and (YE). p^e: preset price.
- $\kappa > 0$: slope of (AS). $\phi \geq 0$: weight on price surprises in the loss L (LF). $\sigma > 0$, i: as in Question 1.

- y^*: the optimal output (in this question). $c > 0$: a level of the loss, $L = c$ (a contour).
- IT line: the targeting rule drawn in the (y, p) plane.
- Lista 7 loss only: $L_7 \equiv \phi_y(y - y^*)^2 + \phi_p(p - p^e)^2$; $\phi_y, \phi_p > 0$ are its weights and y^* there is that list's output target, not the optimum.

Step — substitution. Square both sides of (AS):

$$(p - p^e)^2 = \kappa^2(y - y_n)^2. \tag{27}$$

Substitute (27) into the second term of (LF):

$$\begin{aligned} L &= \tfrac{1}{2}(y - y_e)^2 + \tfrac{\phi}{2\kappa}\left(\kappa^2(y - y_n)^2\right) \\ &= \tfrac{1}{2}(y - y_e)^2 + \tfrac{\phi\kappa}{2}(y - y_n)^2. \end{aligned} \tag{28}$$

Step — FOC. Differentiate (28) with respect to y and set it to zero:

$$\frac{dL}{dy} = (y - y_e) + \phi\kappa\,(y - y_n) = 0. \tag{29}$$

Differentiate once more: $\frac{d^2L}{dy^2} = 1 + \phi\kappa > 0$, so (29) gives a minimum. By (AS), $\kappa(y - y_n) = p - p^e$; substitute this into (29):

$$(y - y_e) + \phi\,(p - p^e) = 0. \tag{30}$$

Collect the y terms of (29):

$$y\,(1 + \phi\kappa) = y_e + \phi\kappa\, y_n.$$

Divide by $1 + \phi\kappa$:

$$y^* = \frac{y_e + \phi\kappa\, y_n}{1 + \phi\kappa}. \tag{31}$$

Step — why AS. i enters only (AD), and by (1) a change in i shifts the AD horizontally by $-\sigma\, di$: any point of the AS can be reached. The AD restricts nothing; the AS (firms' price setting) is the menu of (y, p) the bank can choose from.

Step — geometry. Set (LF) equal to c and divide by c:

$$\frac{(y - y_e)^2}{2c} + \frac{(p - p^e)^2}{2c\kappa/\phi} = 1,$$

an ellipse centred at (y_e, p^e) (a circle iff $\phi = \kappa$). The optimum is the tangency of the lowest ellipse with the AS. Solve (30) for p:

$$p - p^e = -\frac{1}{\phi}\,(y - y_e), \tag{32}$$

the IT line: slope $-1/\phi$, through (y_e, p^e).

Step — Lista 7. Substitute (27) into the Lista 7 loss:

$$L_7 = \phi_y(y - y^*)^2 + \phi_p(\kappa^2(y - y_n)^2).$$

Differentiate with respect to y, set it to zero and divide by 2:

$$\phi_y(y - y^*) + \phi_p\kappa^2(y - y_n) = 0.$$

Replace $\kappa(y - y_n)$ by $p - p^e$ using (AS):

$$\phi_y(y - y^*) + \kappa\phi_p(p - p^e) = 0, \tag{33}$$

the rule in `Map/lista-07.md` (Q4). Put $\phi_y = \frac{1}{2}$, $\phi_p = \frac{\phi}{2\kappa}$, $y^* = y_e$ in (33):

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\tfrac{1}{2}\right)(y - (y_e)) + \kappa\left(\tfrac{\phi}{2\kappa}\right)(p - p^e) &= 0 \\ \tfrac{1}{2}(y - y_e) + \tfrac{\phi}{2}(p - p^e) &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

which is (30) divided by 2. (The instructor's PSET 7 key does not cover Q4; the check is against the project's verified answer.)

Grading rubric.

- Substitution of AS and $dL/dy = 0$ with SOC: 2 pts. Differentiating in i or using a y_e that contains μ (Prova 01, 3.c): max. 1 pt.
- Why AS, contours and IT line: 1.5 pts.
- Lista 7 mapping: 0.5 pt.

b) (3 points) Let $W \equiv y_e - y_n > 0$. Find $y^* - y_e$ and $p^* - p^e$, sign their derivatives in ϕ and κ, and give the limits $\phi \to \infty$ and $\phi = 0$. Relate the answer to the two Carlin–Soskice questions.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). New: $W \equiv y_e - y_n > 0$, the wedge between efficient and natural output. p^*: the optimal price level.
- ∂_ϕ, ∂_κ: partial derivatives with respect to ϕ and κ.

Step — levels. Subtract y_n from (31):

$$\begin{aligned} y^* - y_n &= \frac{y_e + \phi\kappa\, y_n - (1+\phi\kappa)\, y_n}{1+\phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{y_e - y_n}{1+\phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{W}{1+\phi\kappa}. \end{aligned} \tag{34}$$

Subtract $W = y_e - y_n$ from (34):

$$\begin{aligned} y^* - y_e &= \frac{W}{1+\phi\kappa} - W \\ &= -\frac{\phi\kappa\, W}{1+\phi\kappa}. \end{aligned} \tag{35}$$

By (AS), $p^* - p^e = \kappa(y^* - y_n)$. Substitute (34):

$$\begin{aligned} p^* - p^e &= \kappa\Big(\frac{W}{1+\phi\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{\kappa W}{1+\phi\kappa}. \end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

Step — derivatives. Differentiate (36) with respect to ϕ:

$$\partial_\phi(p^* - p^e) = -\frac{\kappa^2 W}{(1+\phi\kappa)^2} < 0.$$

Differentiate (36) with respect to κ (quotient rule):

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_\kappa(p^* - p^e) &= \frac{(1+\phi\kappa) - \phi\kappa}{(1+\phi\kappa)^2}\, W \\ &= \frac{W}{(1+\phi\kappa)^2} > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Differentiate (35) with respect to ϕ and to κ:

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_\phi(y^* - y_e) &= -\frac{\kappa W}{(1+\phi\kappa)^2} < 0, \\ \partial_\kappa(y^* - y_e) &= -\frac{\phi W}{(1+\phi\kappa)^2} < 0. \end{aligned}$$

Step — limits. Let $\phi \to \infty$ in (34) and (36): $y^* \to y_n$, $p^* \to p^e$ (strict price stability). Put $\phi = 0$ in (35) and (36): $y^* = y_e$, $p^* - p^e = \kappa W$.

Step — Carlin–Soskice. More inflation aversion (ϕ, their β) flattens the IT/MR line (32) (slope $-1/\phi$): less of the wedge into prices, more into output. A steeper AS (κ, their α) makes each unit of output above y_n cost more price surprise.

Grading rubric.

- Levels: 1 pt.
- Four signed derivatives: 1 pt.
- Limits and the analogy: 1 pt.

c) (3 points) For a shock with changes dy_n, dy_e, $d\bar{y}$ (g, $\bar{p}$, p^e fixed), find di^* and prove that it depends on ϕ if and only if $dy_n \neq dy_e$. Apply the result to news of a higher $\bar{\mu}$.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a) and (b). dy_n, dy_e, $d\bar{y}$: the shock's changes in natural, efficient and long-run output.
- New: $X \equiv dy_e - dy_n$, the change in the wedge W. i^*: the optimal rate. $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$, $\bar{\mu}$: as in Question 1.

Step — optimum. Differentiate (31):

$$dy^* = \frac{dy_e + \phi\kappa\, dy_n}{1 + \phi\kappa}. \tag{37}$$

Write $dy_n = dy_e - X$ in (37):

$$\begin{aligned} dy^* &= \frac{dy_e + \phi\kappa\,(dy_e - X)}{1 + \phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{(1 + \phi\kappa)\, dy_e - \phi\kappa X}{1 + \phi\kappa} \\ &= dy_e - \frac{\phi\kappa X}{1 + \phi\kappa}. \end{aligned} \tag{38}$$

By (2) with $dp^e = 0$, $dp^* = \kappa(dy^* - dy_n)$. From (37), $dy^* - dy_n = \frac{dy_e - dy_n}{1+\phi\kappa} = \frac{X}{1+\phi\kappa}$, so

$$\begin{aligned} dp^* &= \kappa\Big(\frac{X}{1 + \phi\kappa}\Big) \\ &= \frac{\kappa X}{1 + \phi\kappa}. \end{aligned} \tag{39}$$

Step — rate. Put $dg = d\bar{g} = d\bar{p} = 0$ in (1):

$$dy^* = d\bar{y} - \sigma\, di^* - \sigma\, dp^*.$$

Solve for di^*:

$$di^* = \frac{d\bar{y} - dy^* - \sigma\, dp^*}{\sigma}. \tag{40}$$

Add (38) and σ times (39):

$$\begin{aligned} dy^* + \sigma\, dp^* &= \Big(dy_e - \frac{\phi\kappa X}{1 + \phi\kappa}\Big) + \sigma\Big(\frac{\kappa X}{1 + \phi\kappa}\Big) \\ &= dy_e + \frac{(\sigma - \phi)\,\kappa X}{1 + \phi\kappa}. \end{aligned}$$

Substitute this into (40):

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= \frac{d\bar{y} - \Big(dy_e + \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa X}{1+\phi\kappa}\Big)}{\sigma} \\ &= \frac{d\bar{y} - dy_e}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma - \phi)\,\kappa X}{\sigma(1 + \phi\kappa)}. \end{aligned} \tag{41}$$

Step — proof. Only the last term of (41) contains ϕ. Differentiate its ϕ part (quotient rule):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial\phi}\,\frac{-(\sigma - \phi)}{1 + \phi\kappa} &= \frac{(1 + \phi\kappa) + (\sigma - \phi)\kappa}{(1 + \phi\kappa)^2} \\ &= \frac{1 + \sigma\kappa}{(1 + \phi\kappa)^2}. \end{aligned}$$

Multiply by $\frac{\kappa X}{\sigma}$:

$$\frac{\partial di^*}{\partial \phi} = \frac{\kappa(1+\sigma\kappa)\,X}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)^2}, \tag{42}$$

zero iff $X = 0$. With $X = 0$, $dy_e = dy_n$; substitute both into (41):

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= \frac{d\bar{y} - (dy_n)}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa\,(0)}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)} \\ &= \frac{d\bar{y} - dy_n}{\sigma}, \end{aligned}$$

the strict price-stability rate ((M) with $d(y - y_n) = 0$).

Step — $\bar{\mu}$ news. By (YN) and (YE), $dy_n = dy_e = 0$, so $X = 0$; by (YB), $d\bar{y} = -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}$. Substitute into (41):

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= \frac{(-d\bar{\mu}/\Omega) - (0)}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa\,(0)}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)} \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} < 0 \end{aligned}$$

for every ϕ, as in Prova 01, 3.c (error analysis, Q3).

Economic intuition. ϕ chooses a point on the AS only when the shock separates y_n from y_e; otherwise the best point is unique and the bank just moves AD back to it.

Grading rubric.

- di^* in closed form: 1.5 pts.
- Proof of the iff: 1 pt.
- Application, with "cut, for any ϕ": 0.5 pt.

Block 2 — Harder and conceptual: which bar moves which curve, signs, divine coincidence, zero bound

(Benigno §§4–11 • 38 points)

Question 5. (10 points) *Which bar moves which curve.* Consider a small rise, one at a time, in each of $a, \bar{a}, \mu, \bar{\mu}, g, \bar{g}, \bar{p}, p^e$.

a) (6 points) Build a table with, for each variable: the curve that moves and its shift (horizontal for AD and AS; vertical for p^e); whether y_e moves; whether there is a trade-off; and the di (sign and closed form) that keeps $y = y_n$ and $p = p^e$.

Notation.

- y, p, $\bar{y}$, $\bar{p}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i, a, $\bar{a}$, μ, $\bar{\mu}$, g, $\bar{g}$, $\sigma > 0$, $\eta > 0$, $\kappa > 0$, $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$: as in Question 1. Each row is a small rise $d(\cdot) > 0$ in one variable, the others fixed; $\bar{p}$ and p^e move only in their own rows.
- Trade-off: price stability and $y = y_e$ cannot both be reached with i.

Step — method. By (2) the AS shifts horizontally by dy_n (or vertically by dp^e); by (1) the AD shifts horizontally by $d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} + \sigma\, d\bar{p}$. $y = y_n$ and $p = p^e$ mean $d(y - y_n) = 0$; put this in (M) of Question 1:

$$0 = d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - \sigma\, di + \sigma(d\bar{p} - dp^e) - dy_n.$$

Solve for di:

$$di = \frac{d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - dy_n}{\sigma} + d\bar{p} - dp^e. \tag{43}$$

Each row fills (43) with the derivatives of (YN) and (YB); y_e moves by the derivative of (YE).

Rise in	Curve that moves (shift)	Through	y_e moves?	Trade-off?	di for $p = p^e$
a	AS right, $\frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}da$	y_n	yes, equally	no	$-\frac{(1+\eta)da}{\sigma\Omega}$ (cut)
$\bar{a}$	AD right, $\frac{1+\eta}{\Omega}d\bar{a}$	$\bar{y}$	no	no	$+\frac{(1+\eta)d\bar{a}}{\sigma\Omega}$ (raise)
μ	AS left, $\frac{1}{\Omega}d\mu$	y_n	**no**	**yes**	$+\frac{d\mu}{\sigma\Omega}$ (raise)
$\bar{\mu}$	AD left, $\frac{1}{\Omega}d\bar{\mu}$	$\bar{y}$	no	no	$-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}$ (cut)
g	AD right dg; AS right $\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}dg$	both	yes, equally	no	$+\frac{\eta\,dg}{\sigma\Omega}$ (raise)
$\bar{g}$	AD left, $\frac{\eta}{\Omega}d\bar{g}$	$\bar{y}-\bar{g}$	no	no	$-\frac{\eta\,d\bar{g}}{\sigma\Omega}$ (cut)
$\bar{p}$	AD right, $\sigma\,d\bar{p}$	$\bar{p}-p$	no	no	$+d\bar{p}$ (raise)
p^e	AS up, dp^e (vertical)	p^e	no	no	$-dp^e$ (cut)

Step — the two subtle rows. $\bar{g}$: by (YB), $d\bar{y} = \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}d\bar{g}$. The AD shift is then

$$\begin{aligned} d\bar{y} - d\bar{g} &= \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\,d\bar{g}\Big) - d\bar{g} \\ &= \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega} - 1\Big)d\bar{g} \\ &= \frac{\sigma^{-1} - \sigma^{-1} - \eta}{\Omega}\,d\bar{g} \\ &= -\frac{\eta}{\Omega}\,d\bar{g} \end{aligned} \tag{44}$$

(long-run consumption falls); (43) gives $di = -\frac{\eta\,d\bar{g}}{\sigma\Omega}$. g: by (YN), $dy_n = \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}dg$, so the gap pressure in (43) is

$$\begin{aligned} dg - dy_n &= dg - \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\,dg\Big) \\ &= \frac{\eta}{\Omega}\,dg, \end{aligned}$$

by the same step as (44). p^e: with p^e higher and $\bar{p}$ fixed, $p = p^e$ means lower expected inflation $\bar{p} - p$, so a higher real rate; by (43), i must fall one for one.

Grading rubric.

- One point per correct pair of rows (curve, shift, y_e, trade-off, di), up to 6. A row with the wrong curve: 0 for that row.

b) (2 points) In words: state the rule that tells you which curve a variable moves.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). Euler equation: the household's condition linking consumption today to expected long-run consumption.

Step — rule. Current real fundamentals (a, μ, g) change what firms can produce at stable prices today, so they move y_n and the AS. Long-run fundamentals ($\bar{a}$, $\bar{\mu}$, $\bar{g}$) change long-run consumption, which reaches today only through the Euler equation, so they move the AD. g is also spending today, so it moves both. Nominal anchors: $\bar{p}$ moves the AD (expected inflation), p^e the AS.

Grading rubric.

- Rule with the Euler channel for the bars: 2 pts; a list without the reason: 1 pt.

c) (2 points) In words: why is μ the only row with a trade-off?

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a).

Step — reason. Subtract (YE) from (YN):

$$y_n - y_e = -\frac{\mu}{\Omega}. \tag{45}$$

A trade-off exists iff the shock moves (45). Only current μ enters y_n without entering y_e: the planner does not face the markup. The bars are long-run variables, and the short-run gap between y_n and y_e does not contain them.

Ref: Benigno (2015), §4.1–§4.4, eqs. (15), (19), (21), pp. 507–509; §§6–8, pp. 511–517; Kurlat (2020), §11.2, p. 208 (Fisher equation, row $\bar{p}$).

Grading rubric.

- The criterion $d(y_n - y_e) \neq 0$: 1 pt.
- Why the bars do not enter it: 1 pt.

Question 6. (8 points) *Diagnose the answer (words only, no algebra).* News arrives that the long-run markup will rise ($d\bar{\mu} > 0$; current μ unchanged). A student writes four claims. For each, say whether it is right and, if not, correct it in words.

(1) "Firms will charge higher markups, so the AS shifts left."

(2) "Along the AD, prices go up and output goes down."

(3) "To keep prices stable the bank must raise i, accepting a deeper recession as the price of stable prices."

(4) "The optimal response depends on whether ϕ is larger than σ, i.e. on whether the IT line is flatter than the AD."

Notation.

- μ, $\bar{\mu}$: current and long-run markup; here $d\bar{\mu} > 0$, $d\mu = 0$. y, p, $\bar{y}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i: as in Question 1.
- $\phi \geq 0$: weight on price surprises in (LF); $\sigma > 0$: intertemporal elasticity (the slope of AD is $-1/\sigma$ in (y, p)).

Step — (1) wrong. Today's prices are set with today's markup μ, which has not changed; by (YN), y_n and the AS do not move. By (YB) the news lowers long-run output $\bar{y}$, hence expected long-run consumption; consumption smoothing cuts spending today: the **AD** shifts left.

Step — (2) wrong. "p up, y down" is the signature of an AS shift, which did not happen. The AD moves left along a fixed AS, so the new point has *both* lower output and lower prices: a demand-driven recession, $y - y_n < 0$ and $y - y_e < 0$.

Step — (3) wrong sign, wrong cost. Prices are below p^e; to restore them the bank must bring the AD back to the right: **cut** i. A rise deepens both the fall in prices and the recession. The cut has no cost: it returns the economy to the initial point, where both gaps are zero (a pure AD shock; divine coincidence).

Step — (4) wrong. ϕ chooses a point on the AS only when the shock separates y_n from y_e ((42), Question 4(c)). Here neither moves, so the best point is the old one for every ϕ, and the bank fully offsets the AD shift. ($\phi \gtrless \sigma$ decides the sign only for a current markup shock, Question 3(c).)

Ref: `Prova/prova-01-error-analysis.md`, Q3 and error cluster 5; Benigno (2015), §6.3, p. 513; §11, pp. 521–523.

Grading rubric.

- 2 pts per claim: 0.5 for the verdict, 1.5 for the correction with its mechanism. A verdict without a reason: 0.5 at most.

Question 7. (9 points) *When does the divine coincidence fail?* True or false; justify each in words (1.5 points each).

a) If nominal wages were preset as well as prices, a productivity shock could create a trade-off between price stability and the efficient output gap.

Answer: T

Notation.

- y_n, y_e: natural and efficient output, (YN) and (YE); trade-off as in Question 5. g, μ, $\bar{a}$, $\bar{\mu}$, i: as in Question 1; $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$, $\sigma, \eta > 0$. $\phi \geq 0$: weight in (LF). These symbols serve all six items.

Step — reason. The no-trade-off result for productivity rests on flexible wages: they make y_n move one for one with y_e. With preset wages the real wage cannot follow productivity, and y_n and y_e separate (Benigno fn. 9, p. 513).

b) A temporary rise in g forces the bank to choose between stable prices and a zero efficient gap.

Answer: F

Step — reason. Differentiating (YN) and (YE), g moves y_n and y_e by the same $\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}dg$. Raising i to put y at y_n also puts it at y_e: one instrument, one target.

c) Around a steady state with a large markup distortion, y_e need not be the welfare-relevant target, and the results for markup shocks are the ones most at risk.

Answer: T

Step — reason. The quadratic loss is an approximation around an efficient steady state; in the distorted case the target changes and the optimal response to markup shocks is what changes most (Benigno fn. 21, p. 522).

d) A temporary rise in the consumption tax is a pure demand shock, so it creates no trade-off.

Answer: F

Step — reason. It raises the effective markup (AS left, y_n falls, y_e does not) *and* changes the intertemporal price of consumption (AD). The markup part separates y_n from y_e: a trade-off (Benigno §8, p. 515).

e) After bad news about $\bar{a}$, if the zero bound binds, the bank faces a trade-off between price stability and the efficient gap.

Answer: F

Step — reason. Both targets ask for the same thing: more demand, since prices and output are both too low. The zero bound limits the instrument; it does not make the targets conflict. The coincidence holds; it just cannot be implemented with i alone.

f) A dovish bank ($\phi < \sigma$) answers news of a higher $\bar{\mu}$ with a larger cut than a hawkish bank.

Answer: F

Step — reason. The cut is $\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}$ for every ϕ ((41) with $X = 0$, Question 4(c)): the news moves neither y_n nor y_e.

Grading rubric.

- Each item: 0.5 for the verdict, 1 for the justification. A verdict without a justification: 0.5 at most (T/F rule of the cover applies to the verdicts).

Question 8. (11 points) *The zero bound after $\bar{\mu}$ news.* Start from the steady state with $i = \rho > 0$. News arrives that the long-run markup will rise, $d\bar{\mu} > 0$; current μ is unchanged and the bank cannot set $i < 0$.

a) (3 points) Find the rate that keeps $p = p^e$ and the size $d\bar{\mu}^*$ above which the zero bound binds. Interpret with the natural rate.

Notation.

- y, p, $\bar{y}$, $\bar{p}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i, μ, $\bar{\mu}$, g, $\sigma > 0$, $\eta > 0$, $\kappa > 0$, $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$: as in Question 1.
- $\rho \equiv -\ln\beta > 0$: the initial rate, $i = \rho$ (at the steady state (AD) holds with $y = \bar{y}$, $p = \bar{p}$, $g = \bar{g}$). The zero bound: $i \geq 0$.
- The shock: $d\bar{\mu} > 0$, $d\mu = 0$. $d\bar{\mu}^* > 0$: the size at which the zero bound starts to bind.
- $r_n \equiv \rho + \sigma^{-1}(\bar{y} - y_n)$: the natural real interest rate.

Step — rate. By (YB), $d\bar{y} = -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}$; by (YN), $dy_n = 0$. Put $d(y - y_n) = 0$ in (M):

$$0 = d\bar{y} - \sigma\, di.$$

Solve for di and substitute $d\bar{y}$:

$$\begin{aligned} di &= \frac{d\bar{y}}{\sigma} \\ &= \frac{(-d\bar{\mu}/\Omega)}{\sigma} \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}. \end{aligned} \tag{46}$$

Add (46) to the initial $i = \rho$:

$$\begin{aligned} i &= \rho + \Big(- \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} \Big) \\ &= \rho - \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}. \end{aligned} \tag{47}$$

Step — threshold. The rate (47) is negative iff

$$\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} > \rho.$$

Multiply by $\sigma\Omega > 0$:

$$d\bar{\mu} > d\bar{\mu}^* \equiv \sigma\Omega\rho. \tag{48}$$

Step — reading. Initially $\bar{y} = y_n$, so $r_n = \rho$. After the news, $dr_n = \sigma^{-1} d\bar{y}$; substitute $d\bar{y}$ from (YB) into $r_n = \rho + dr_n$:

$$\begin{aligned} r_n &= \rho + \sigma^{-1} \Big(- \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} \Big) \\ &= \rho - \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}, \end{aligned}$$

the rate (47) is the natural rate. Bad enough news makes it negative, and no nominal $i \geq 0$ reaches it.

Grading rubric.

- Rate: 1.5 pts. Threshold: 1 pt. Natural-rate reading: 0.5 pt.

b) (3 points) Let $d\bar{\mu} > d\bar{\mu}^*$ and $i = 0$. Find dy, dp, $d(y - y_n)$, $d(y - y_e)$. Is there a trade-off?

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a); here $d\bar{\mu} > d\bar{\mu}^*$.

Step — solution. Going from $i = \rho$ to $i = 0$ is $di = -\rho$. Put this and $d\bar{y} = -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}$ in (M):

$$\begin{aligned} (1 + \sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) &= \Big(- \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} \Big) - \sigma(-\rho) \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} + \sigma\rho. \end{aligned}$$

Divide by $1 + \sigma\kappa$; as $dy_n = dy_e = 0$, output and both gaps move together:

$$dy = d(y - y_n) = d(y - y_e) = \frac{\sigma\rho - d\bar{\mu}/\Omega}{1 + \sigma\kappa} < 0, \tag{49}$$

negative because (48) gives $d\bar{\mu}/\Omega > \sigma\rho$. By (2), $dp = \kappa\, dy$; substitute (49):

$$\begin{aligned} dp &= \kappa \Big(\frac{\sigma\rho - d\bar{\mu}/\Omega}{1 + \sigma\kappa} \Big) \\ &= \frac{\kappa(\sigma\rho - d\bar{\mu}/\Omega)}{1 + \sigma\kappa} < 0. \end{aligned}$$

Step — trade-off. No: both prices and output are too low; the bank lacks the instrument, not a compatible target (Question 7(e)).

Grading rubric.

- Closed forms: 2 pts.
- No trade-off, with the reason: 1 pt.

c) (3 points) Find the commitment $d\bar{p}$ that restores $y = y_n$ and $p = p^e$ with $i = 0$. Explain the channel and why credibility matters.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). $d\bar{p}$: the promised change in the long-run price level. $\bar{p}-p$: expected inflation; $i-(\bar{p}-p)$: the real rate.

Step — size. Put $d(y-y_n)=0$, $di=-\rho$, $d\bar{y}=-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}$ and $d\bar{p}$ in (M):

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \Big(-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}\Big) - \sigma(-\rho) + \sigma\, d\bar{p} \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} + \sigma\rho + \sigma\, d\bar{p}. \end{aligned}$$

Solve for $d\bar{p}$:

$$d\bar{p} = \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} - \rho > 0, \tag{50}$$

positive by (48).

Step — channel. A higher long-run price level raises expected inflation $\bar{p}-p$, so the real rate $i-(\bar{p}-p)$ falls with i stuck at 0 (Fisher equation; long-run neutrality makes $\bar{p}$ costless for $\bar{y}$).

Step — credibility. Next period the bank would prefer not to deliver the higher $\bar{p}$; if households expect it to renege, $\bar{p}$ does not move and neither does the AD.

Ref: Benigno (2015), §9, pp. 517–519; Kurlat (2020), §11.2, p. 208.

Grading rubric.

- $d\bar{p}$: 1.5 pts.
- Channel: 1 pt.
- Credibility: 0.5 pt.

d) (2 points) Alternatively, find the temporary dg that restores $p=p^e$ at $i=0$, and say why fiscal policy works here.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). dg: the temporary rise in public spending ($d\bar{g}=0$).

Step — size. Differentiate (YN) with only g moving:

$$dy_n = \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, dg. \tag{51}$$

Put $d(y-y_n)=0$, $di=-\rho$, $d\bar{y}=-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}$, dg and (51) in (M):

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \Big(-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}\Big) + dg - \sigma(-\rho) - \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, dg\Big) \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} + \sigma\rho + dg - \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, dg. \end{aligned}$$

Use $1-\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}=\frac{\eta}{\Omega}$ (as in (44)):

$$0 = -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} + \sigma\rho + \Big(\frac{\eta}{\Omega}\Big) dg.$$

Move the other terms to the left side:

$$\frac{\eta}{\Omega}\, dg = \frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} - \sigma\rho.$$

Multiply by Ω/η:

$$dg = \frac{d\bar{\mu} - \sigma\Omega\rho}{\eta} > 0, \tag{52}$$

positive by (48).

Step — why. By (1) g shifts the AD by dg, and by (51) the AS only by $\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega} dg$, so it closes the gap; with i stuck, there is no rate rise to crowd it out.

Ref: Benigno (2015), §8, pp. 514–517; §9, pp. 517–519.

Grading rubric.

- *dg*: 1.5 pts.
- Reason: 0.5 pt.

Block 3 — Created items: two shocks at once, and the timing of fiscal news

(created • 22 points)

Question 9. (12 points) *Created.* An oil-price rise lifts the current markup, $d\mu > 0$, and in the same week a law is passed that raises a payroll tax from next period on, $d\bar{\mu} > 0$. The bank minimizes L with a general $\phi \geq 0$.

a) (3 points) With i fixed: which curves move? Find dy, dp, $d(y - y_n)$, $d(y - y_e)$. When do prices rise?

Notation.

- y, p, $\bar{y}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i, $\sigma > 0$, $\eta > 0$, $\kappa > 0$, $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$: as in Question 1.
- The shocks: $d\mu > 0$ (current markup) and $d\bar{\mu} > 0$ (long-run markup), at the same time.
- $\phi \geq 0$: weight on price surprises in (LF). y^*, p^*, i^*: optimal output, price and rate.

Step — curves. Differentiate (YN), (YB) and (YE):

$$dy_n = -\frac{d\mu}{\Omega}, \qquad d\bar{y} = -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega}, \qquad dy_e = 0. \tag{53}$$

So the AS shifts left (by $|dy_n|$) and, by (1), the AD shifts left (by $|d\bar{y}|$).

Step — solution. Put (53) in (M) with $di = 0$:

$$\begin{aligned}(1 + \sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) &= \Big(-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} \Big) - \Big(-\frac{d\mu}{\Omega} \Big) \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega} + \frac{d\mu}{\Omega}.\end{aligned}$$

Divide by $1 + \sigma\kappa$:

$$d(y - y_n) = \frac{d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)}. \tag{54}$$

By (2), $dp = \kappa\, d(y - y_n)$; substitute (54):

$$\begin{aligned}dp &= \kappa\Big(\frac{d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} \Big) \\ &= \frac{\kappa(d\mu - d\bar{\mu})}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)}.\end{aligned} \tag{55}$$

Output is $dy = dy_n + d(y - y_n)$; substitute (53) and (54):

$$\begin{aligned}dy &= \Big(-\frac{d\mu}{\Omega} \Big) + \Big(\frac{d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} \Big) \\ &= -\frac{d\mu}{\Omega} + \frac{d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} \\ &= \frac{-(1 + \sigma\kappa)\, d\mu + d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} \\ &= -\frac{\sigma\kappa\, d\mu + d\bar{\mu}}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} < 0.\end{aligned} \tag{56}$$

Since $dy_e = 0$, $d(y - y_e) = dy < 0$.

Step — prices. By (55), $dp > 0$ iff $d\mu > d\bar{\mu}$: the supply shift dominates the demand shift.

Grading rubric.

- Both curves, each with its reason: 1 pt. Only one curve moved: max. 1 pt for the item.

- Closed forms: 1.5 pts.
- Price condition: 0.5 pt.

b) (4 points) Find dy^*, dp^*, di^* under the optimal rule. Split di^* into a part due to $d\bar{\mu}$ and a part due to $d\mu$; show which depends on ϕ; sign $\partial di^*/\partial\phi$; give the limits $\phi \to \infty$ and $\phi = 0$, and the condition for a cut.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). $X \equiv dy_e - dy_n$: change in the wedge, as in Question 4(c).

Step — optimum. By (53), $dy_e = 0$ and $X = -dy_n = \frac{d\mu}{\Omega}$. Put these in (37):

$$\begin{aligned} dy^* &= \frac{\phi\kappa\, dy_n}{1+\phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{\phi\kappa\,(-d\mu/\Omega)}{1+\phi\kappa} \\ &= -\frac{\phi\kappa\, d\mu}{\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)}. \end{aligned} \tag{57}$$

Put $X = \frac{d\mu}{\Omega}$ in (39):

$$\begin{aligned} dp^* &= \frac{\kappa\,(d\mu/\Omega)}{1+\phi\kappa} \\ &= \frac{\kappa\, d\mu}{\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)}. \end{aligned} \tag{58}$$

$d\bar{\mu}$ is absent from both.

Step — rate. Put $dy_e = 0$ and $X = \frac{d\mu}{\Omega}$ in (41):

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= \frac{d\bar{y}}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa\,(d\mu/\Omega)}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)} \\ &= \frac{d\bar{y}}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)}. \end{aligned}$$

Substitute $d\bar{y}$ from (53):

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= \frac{(-d\bar{\mu}/\Omega)}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)} \\ &= \underbrace{-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}}_{\text{news: cut, any } \phi} + \underbrace{\frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)}}_{\text{current shock: sign of } \phi-\sigma}. \end{aligned} \tag{59}$$

Step — ϕ. Put $X = \frac{d\mu}{\Omega}$ in (42):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial di^*}{\partial\phi} &= \frac{\kappa(1+\sigma\kappa)\,(d\mu/\Omega)}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)^2} \\ &= \frac{\kappa(1+\sigma\kappa)\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)^2} > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Limits: as $\phi \to \infty$, $\frac{\phi-\sigma}{1+\phi\kappa} \to \frac{1}{\kappa}$, so (59) tends to

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &\to -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} + \Big(\frac{1}{\kappa}\Big)\frac{\kappa\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega} \\ &= \frac{d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega}, \end{aligned}$$

strict price stability (equal to (M) with $d(y-y_n)=0$). At $\phi=0$, $\frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)}=-\kappa$, so (59) gives

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} + (-\kappa)\frac{d\mu}{\Omega} \\ &= -\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} - \frac{\kappa\, d\mu}{\Omega}. \end{aligned}$$

Step — cut. By (59), $di^*<0$ iff

$$\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} > \frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)}.$$

Multiply by $\sigma\Omega>0$:

$$d\bar{\mu} > \frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)}{1+\phi\kappa}\, d\mu, \tag{60}$$

always true if $\phi\le\sigma$ (the right side is then ≤ 0).

Economic intuition. Contrast with Prova 01: there only the news part existed, so ϕ did not matter. Here ϕ matters, but only through the current markup, the one shock that separates y_n from y_e.

Grading rubric.

- dy^*, dp^* from the rule on AS: 1 pt.
- di^* and its split: 1.5 pts. Attributing ϕ-dependence to the news part: max. 1.5 pts for the item.
- Derivative, limits and cut condition: 1.5 pts.

c) (2 points) Let the two shocks be equal, $d\bar{\mu}=d\mu$ (a permanent markup rise). Show that the optimal bank cuts for every ϕ, and explain why, although with i fixed prices do not move.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a); here $d\bar{\mu}=d\mu>0$.

Step — algebra. Put $d\bar{\mu}=d\mu$ in (59) and factor out $\frac{d\mu}{\sigma\Omega}$:

$$\begin{aligned} di^* &= -\frac{(d\mu)}{\sigma\Omega} + \frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)} \\ &= \frac{d\mu}{\sigma\Omega}\Big[-1+\frac{\kappa(\phi-\sigma)}{1+\phi\kappa}\Big] \\ &= \frac{d\mu}{\sigma\Omega}\cdot\frac{-1-\phi\kappa+\phi\kappa-\sigma\kappa}{1+\phi\kappa} \\ &= -\frac{(1+\sigma\kappa)\, d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1+\phi\kappa)} < 0. \end{aligned}$$

Step — why. With i fixed, put $d\bar{\mu}=d\mu$ in (54):

$$\begin{aligned} d(y-y_n) &= \frac{d\mu-(d\mu)}{\Omega(1+\sigma\kappa)} \\ &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

and the same numerator in (55) gives $dp=0$: the economy already sits at strict price stability, on the new y_n, below y_e. Any finite ϕ wants a point on the AS between y_n and y_e, i.e. more output, so the AD must move right: a cut. As $\phi\to\infty$ the cut vanishes.

Grading rubric.

- Algebra: 1 pt.
- Reason: 1 pt.

d) (3 points) Draw the AS–AD diagram with $\sigma=1$, $\eta=0.5$ ($\Omega=1.5$), $\kappa=0.5$, $\phi=3$, $d\mu=1.5$, $d\bar{\mu}=0.75$: AS, AS′, AD, AD′, the IT line, E_0, the no-policy point E', the optimum O with its AD, and both gaps at O. Give di^* and its two parts.

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). Values: $\sigma = 1$, $\eta = 0.5$, $\Omega = 1.5$, $\kappa = 0.5$, $\phi = 3$, $d\mu = 1.5$, $d\bar{\mu} = 0.75$; so $\sigma\kappa = 0.5$, $\phi\kappa = 1.5$.
- E_0: initial point $(0, 0)$ in (dy, dp). E': no-policy point. O: the optimum. PS: strict price stability. AD*: the AD after di^*.

Step — numbers. From (53):

$$dy_n = -\tfrac{1.5}{1.5} = -1, \qquad d\bar{y} = -\tfrac{0.75}{1.5} = -0.5.$$

E' from (56) and (55):

$$dy = -\frac{0.5 \cdot 1.5 + 0.75}{1.5 \cdot 1.5} = -\frac{2}{3},$$
$$dp = \frac{0.5\,(1.5 - 0.75)}{1.5 \cdot 1.5} = \frac{1}{6}.$$

O from (57) and (58):

$$dy^* = -\frac{1.5 \cdot 1.5}{1.5 \cdot 2.5} = -0.6,$$
$$dp^* = \frac{0.5 \cdot 1.5}{1.5 \cdot 2.5} = 0.2.$$

The two parts of (59):

$$-\frac{d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} = -\frac{0.75}{1 \cdot 1.5} = -0.5,$$
$$\frac{\kappa(\phi - \sigma)\,d\mu}{\sigma\Omega(1 + \phi\kappa)} = \frac{0.5 \cdot 2 \cdot 1.5}{1 \cdot 1.5 \cdot 2.5} = \frac{1.5}{3.75} = 0.4.$$

Add them:

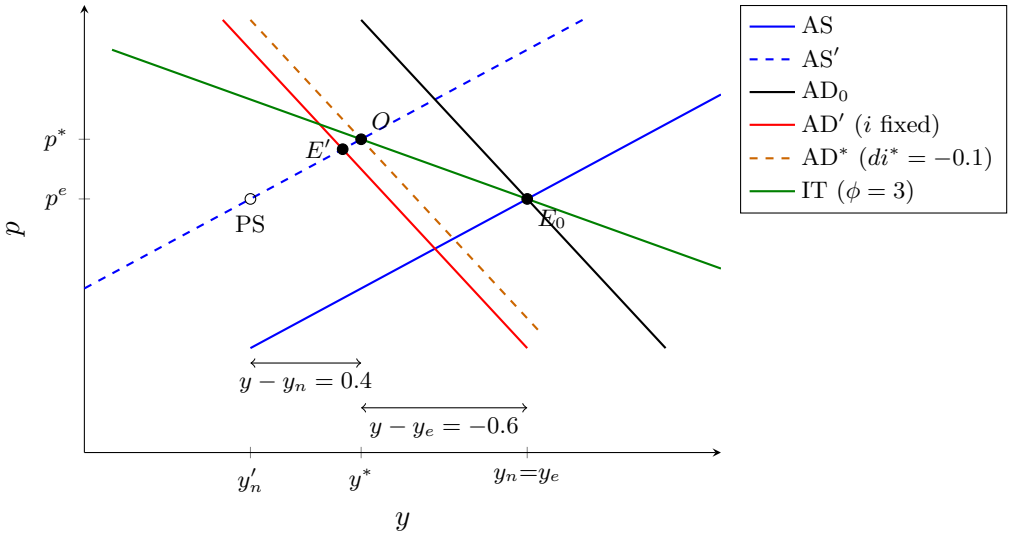
$$di^* = -0.5 + 0.4 = -0.1.$$

Gaps at O, using $dy_n = -1$ and $dy_e = 0$:

$$y - y_n = -0.6 - (-1) = 0.4,$$
$$y - y_e = -0.6 - 0 = -0.6.$$

Strict price stability would be $(-1, 0)$, with the rate from (M) at $d(y - y_n) = 0$:

$$di = \frac{d\mu - d\bar{\mu}}{\sigma\Omega} = \frac{1.5 - 0.75}{1.5} = 0.5.$$



Grading rubric.

- Numbers: 1 pt.
- Graph (scored on its own): both AS, both AD, IT through (y_e, p^e) with slope $-1/\phi$, E_0, E', O, both gaps: 2 pts.

Question 10. (10 points) *Created.* Public spending rises by $\Delta > 0$ in three ways: (i) temporarily, $dg = \Delta$, $d\bar{g} = 0$; (ii) permanently, $dg = d\bar{g} = \Delta$; (iii) as news only, $d\bar{g} = \Delta$, $dg = 0$.

a) (4 points) For each case: which curves move and by how much; dy, dp, $d(y - y_n)$ with i fixed; and $d(y - y_e)$.

Notation.

- y, p, $\bar{y}$, p^e, y_n, y_e, i, g, $\bar{g}$, $\sigma > 0$, $\eta > 0$, $\kappa > 0$, $\Omega \equiv \sigma^{-1} + \eta$: as in Question 1.
- $\Delta > 0$: the size of the spending rise. Cases (i) $dg = \Delta$, $d\bar{g} = 0$; (ii) $dg = d\bar{g} = \Delta$; (iii) $dg = 0$, $d\bar{g} = \Delta$.
- $\phi \geq 0$: weight in (LF). y^*, p^*, i^*: optimal output, price and rate. E_0, E': initial and no-policy points.

Step — shifts. Differentiate (YN) and (YE):

$$dy_n = dy_e = \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, dg. \tag{61}$$

So the AS shifts by dy_n. By (1) and (YB), the AD shifts by

$$d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} = \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\, d\bar{g}\Big) + dg - d\bar{g}. \tag{62}$$

(i) AD $+\Delta$, AS $+\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta$. (ii) AD $+\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta$, AS $+\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta$. (iii) using (44), AD $(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega} - 1)\Delta = -\frac{\eta}{\Omega}\Delta$, AS still. In all, (61) gives $dy_e = dy_n$, so $d(y - y_e) = d(y - y_n)$.

Step — (i). Put the shifts of (i) in (M), with $1 - \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega} = \frac{\eta}{\Omega}$:

$$\begin{aligned}(1 + \sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) &= (\Delta) - \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta\Big) \\ &= \frac{\eta}{\Omega}\Delta.\end{aligned}$$

Divide by $1 + \sigma\kappa$:

$$d(y - y_n) = \frac{\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)}. \tag{63}$$

By (2), $dp = \kappa\, d(y - y_n)$; substitute (63):

$$\begin{aligned}dp &= \kappa\Big(\frac{\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)}\Big) \\ &= \frac{\kappa\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)}.\end{aligned}$$

Output is $dy = dy_n + d(y - y_n)$; use (61) and (63):

$$\begin{aligned}dy &= \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}\Delta}{\Omega}\Big) + \Big(\frac{\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)}\Big) \\ &= \frac{(\sigma^{-1} + \kappa + \eta)\,\Delta}{\Omega(1 + \sigma\kappa)} \\ &= \frac{(1 + \kappa/\Omega)\,\Delta}{1 + \sigma\kappa}.\end{aligned}$$

Step — (ii). Put the shifts of (ii) in (M):

$$(1 + \sigma\kappa)\, d(y - y_n) = \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta\Big) + (\Delta) - (\Delta) - \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta\Big).$$

Divide by $1+\sigma\kappa$:

$$d(y-y_n) = \frac{1}{1+\sigma\kappa}\Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta - \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta\Big) = 0.$$

So $dp = 0$ by (2), and $dy = dy_n = \frac{\sigma^{-1}\Delta}{\Omega}$ by (61).

Step — (iii). Put the shifts of (iii) in (M):

$$\begin{aligned}(1+\sigma\kappa)\, d(y-y_n) &= \Big(\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta\Big) - (\Delta)\\ &= -\frac{\eta}{\Omega}\Delta.\end{aligned}$$

Divide by $1+\sigma\kappa$; $dy_n = 0$, so output moves with the gap:

$$d(y-y_n) = dy = -\frac{\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1+\sigma\kappa)} < 0.$$

By (2), $dp = \kappa\, d(y-y_n)$; substitute the gap:

$$\begin{aligned}dp &= \kappa\Big(-\frac{\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1+\sigma\kappa)}\Big)\\ &= -\frac{\kappa\eta\Delta}{\Omega(1+\sigma\kappa)} < 0.\end{aligned}$$

Grading rubric.

- Shifts, with $d\bar{y} - d\bar{g} = -\frac{\eta}{\Omega}d\bar{g}$: 1.5 pts.
- Three solutions: 2.5 pts (-0.5 per slip).

b) (3 points) Find the optimal di^* in each case and show that ϕ does not enter. Check that (i) and (iii) add up to (ii).

Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). $X \equiv dy_e - dy_n$, as in Question 4(c).

Step — rule. By (61), $dy_n = dy_e$ in every case, so $X = 0$ and (31) gives $y^* = y_n = y_e$, $p^* = p^e$. Redo (40)–(41) with the AD shift $d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g}$ of (1) in place of $d\bar{y}$, and set $X = 0$:

$$\begin{aligned}di^* &= \frac{(d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g}) - (dy_n)}{\sigma} - \frac{(\sigma-\phi)\,\kappa\,(0)}{\sigma(1+\phi\kappa)}\\ &= \frac{d\bar{y} + dg - d\bar{g} - dy_n}{\sigma},\end{aligned} \tag{64}$$

with no ϕ.

Step — cases. Put (62) and (61) in (64), case by case:

$$\begin{aligned}&\text{(i)} \quad di^* = \frac{\Delta - \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta}{\sigma} = \frac{\eta\Delta}{\sigma\Omega} \text{ (raise)},\\ &\text{(ii)} \quad di^* = \frac{\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta - \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta}{\sigma} = 0,\\ &\text{(iii)} \quad di^* = \frac{\frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta - \Delta}{\sigma} = -\frac{\eta\Delta}{\sigma\Omega} \text{ (cut)}.\end{aligned}$$

Add (i) and (iii):

$$\frac{\eta\Delta}{\sigma\Omega} - \frac{\eta\Delta}{\sigma\Omega} = 0,$$

case (ii), by linearity.

Grading rubric.

- Rule and ϕ-independence: 1.5 pts.

- Three rates with signs and the sum: 1.5 pts.

c) (3 points) Draw the three diagrams for $\sigma = 1$, $\eta = \kappa = 0.5$, $\Delta = 1.5$. Then, in words: what is the output multiplier when the bank follows its optimal rule, and how does case (iii) relate to the $\bar{\mu}$ news of Prova 01?

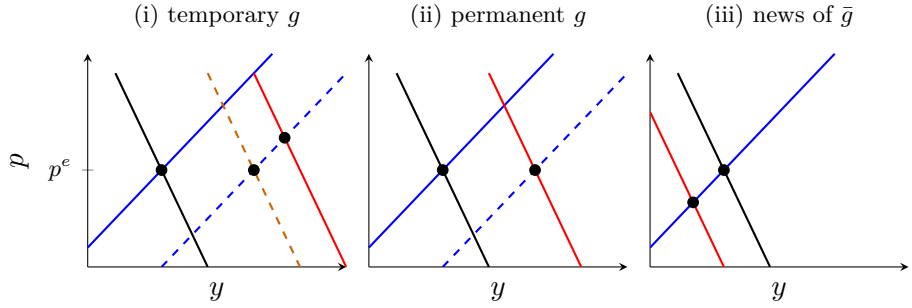
Notation.

- Symbols as in (a). Values: $\sigma = 1$, $\eta = \kappa = 0.5$, $\Delta = 1.5$. Output multiplier: dy/Δ.

Step — numbers. The building blocks:

$$\Omega = 1 + 0.5 = 1.5, \qquad \tfrac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega}\Delta = \tfrac{1.5}{1.5} = 1,$$
$$\tfrac{\eta}{\Omega}\Delta = \tfrac{0.75}{1.5} = 0.5, \qquad 1 + \sigma\kappa = 1.5.$$

(i) By (63), $d(y - y_n) = \frac{0.5}{1.5} = \frac{1}{3}$, so $dy = 1 + \frac{1}{3} = \frac{4}{3}$ and $dp = 0.5 \cdot \frac{1}{3} = \frac{1}{6}$: $E' = (\frac{4}{3}, \frac{1}{6})$. The raise $\frac{\eta\Delta}{\sigma\Omega} = 0.5$ moves it to $(1, 0)$. (ii) $E' = (1, 0)$. (iii) $dy = -\frac{0.5}{1.5} = -\frac{1}{3}$, $dp = 0.5 \cdot (-\frac{1}{3}) = -\frac{1}{6}$: $E' = (-\frac{1}{3}, -\frac{1}{6})$; the cut of 0.5 brings it back to $(0, 0)$.



Blue: AS (dashed: AS′). Black: AD_0. Red: AD′ with i fixed. Orange dashed: AD after the optimal raise in (i). In (iii) the optimal cut returns AD′ to AD_0.

Step — multiplier. Under the optimal rule $y = y_n = y_e$ (part (b)), so by (61), in (i) and (ii), whatever the timing:

$$\frac{dy}{\Delta} = \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\Omega} = \frac{\sigma^{-1}}{\sigma^{-1} + \eta} = \frac{1}{1 + \sigma\eta} < 1,$$

and 0 in (iii), where $dg = 0$. The bank neutralises the demand part of fiscal policy; only its effect on capacity remains.

Step — link to Prova 01. (iii) is a pure AD shock from news about the long run, like $d\bar{\mu} > 0$: AD left, AS still, prices and output fall, and the optimal response is a cut, the same for every ϕ.

Ref: Benigno (2015), §8, Table 1, pp. 514–517; §11, pp. 521–523.

Grading rubric.

- Graphs (scored on their own): shifts and equilibria in the three panels: 1.5 pts.
- Multiplier with the reason: 1 pt.
- Link: 0.5 pt.